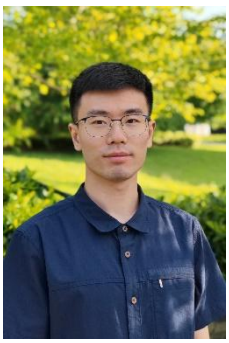
BINGZHI ZHANG



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Last updated: April 2026

EDUCATION

Oct 2021 - June 2026	PhD in Finance Durham University
Sep 2019 - Sep 2020	MSc in Economics Durham University *Average Score: 82.88/100* *Awarded the prize for the Best Overall Academic Performance*
Sep 2017 - Sep 2018	MSc in Money, Banking and Finance University of St Andrews *Average Score: 15.4/20*
Sep 2012 - July 2016	Bachelor's in Economics Tianjin University of Finance and Economics (天津财经大学) *Major Subject: International Finance (average score: 85.58/100)* *Minor Subject: International Accounting (average score: 85.57/100)*

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Financial Intermediation, Financial Markets, Applied Empirical Finance

PUBLICATIONS

"Up the Political Ladder: The Role of Political Networks"
with Xian Gu (Durham University), Iftekhar Hasan (Fordham University), Linda Zhao (University of Pennsylvania) and Yun Zhu (St. John's University)
Journal of Financial Stability, forthcoming

WORKING PAPERS

"Geopolitical Risk and Bank Lending"
with Nikos Paltalidis (University of Bath)
Presented at the DUBS Department of Finance Internal Seminar (2025) and FMA European 2025

"The Impact of Geopolitical Risk on Credit Risk"
with Christos Ioannidis (Aston University) and Nikos Paltalidis (University of Bath)
Presented at the 2nd Finance and Business Analytics Conference, 26th INFER Annual Conference, 17th International Risk Management Conference, 17th NARTI Annual Conference (Excellence in Business Research Awards), 8th Essex Finance Centre (EFiC) Conference in Banking and Corporate Finance, DUBS Department of Finance Internal Seminar (2024), and ICMAIF 2025

WORK IN PROGRESS

"When Firms Speak Up: Corporate Positioning on Social Movements and Its Financial Consequences"
with Xian Gu (Durham University)

"Geopolitical Risk and Knowledge-Network Spillovers"
with Xian Gu (Durham University)

CONFERENCES & ACTIVITIES

Presentation:

2025	DUBS Department of Finance Internal Seminar, ICMAIF 2025, and FMA European
2024	The 2nd Finance and Business Analytics Conference, the 26th INFER Annual Conference, the 17th International Risk Management Conference, the 17th NARTI Annual Conference, the 8th Essex Finance Centre (EFiC) Conference in Banking and Corporate Finance, and DUBS Department of Finance Internal Seminar

Discussion:

2025	ICMAIF 2025 and FMA European
2024	The 2nd Finance and Business Analytics Conference and the 8th Essex Finance Centre (EFiC) Conference

Other Activities:

May 2026	DUBS Doctoral Society Bloomberg Training (scheduled)
September 2025	Volunteer at the International Labour and Employment Relations Association (ILERA) Regional Conference (certificate awarded)
March 2023	BSE Training Course on Introduction to Python and R Programming for Data Science (certificate awarded)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2022-23	ECON47815 Econometric Methods (postgraduate)

	Practical
2022-23	ECON42115 Financial Modelling and Business Forecasting (postgraduate) Practical *Teaching rating: 5/5*
2022-23	ECON42115 Financial Modelling and Business Forecasting (postgraduate) Seminar *Teaching rating: 5/5*

HONOURS & AWARDS

June 2024	Excellence in Business Research Awards *for paper "The Impact of Geopolitical Risk on Credit Risk"* *awarded by the 17th NARTI Annual Conference*
September 2021	Fully funded PhD scholarship
January 2021	Best Overall Academic Performance MSc Economics *awarded by Durham University Business School*
November 2015	Second Prize Scholarship *awarded by Tianjin University of Finance and Economics*
November 2014	Second Prize Scholarship *awarded by Tianjin University of Finance and Economics*